Retirement Plan V68: Review Summary

Review of the workbook (Retirement_Plan_V68.xlsx) and the PDF (Our Retirement Plan V68), 9 November 2026. Focus: annual cash flows, cash savings and surplus, final investment total, and taxes.

Bottom line

The plan holds up. The workbook is internally consistent, the PDF matches it, no year has negative cash flow, the surplus and Trust Cash figures reconcile, the $1,991,217 investment total is correct as built, and the tax calculation is right. Nothing needs fixing.

1. Annual cash flows

- Every year from 2026 to 2042 is positive, including the survivor cases (Ian alone, Stacey alone).
- No account ledger goes negative in any month. The lowest Trust Cash savings balance is $90,148 (June 2030).
- After each July CTP payment the monthly figure is negative ($4,663, $2,209 and $2,620 a month in 2029, 2030 and 2031). The lump sum covers it, and the annual totals stay positive.
- The transition reserve of $31,000 ($12,100 in 2027 plus $18,900 in 2028) covers the $27,976 needed January to June 2029, leaving $3,024.
- Only thin year: 2027, with a $34 surplus. It is -$66 before a $100 reduction in the Joint account float. There is no cushion that year.

	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032
Cash surplus	63,460	34	10,174	102,157	114,383	112,437	18,689
Monthly	5,288	3	848	17,026*	9,532	9,370	1,557

USD. *July to December 2029 average. January to June 2029 is covered by the reserve. Surplus includes Trust Cash interest net of its tax.

2. Cash savings and surplus

- Trust Cash savings (after tax): $102,157 at end-2029, $208,164 at end-2030, $312,007 at end-2031. Adding $21,545 of unallocated cash gives $333,551 available.
- The PDF's $343,837 for end-2031 is correct. It also includes $10,286 of earmarks (property tax, registration and similar). The reserve remnant in that amount is counted once, in the deposit.
- The 2032 surplus of $18,689 is about $10,037 of operating surplus plus $8,653 of interest net of tax.
- All CTP income is taxed before it reaches the surplus. For the July 2029 payment, $58,634 of income tax and $18,298 of payroll tax come out first.
- The cash surplus bridges (2028 to 2029 and 2029 to 2030) add up exactly.

3. Final investment total: $1,991,217 at end-2032

I rebuilt the brokerage account, both IRAs, the Roth and traditional 401(k)s, the SIPP, the Bank of America stock and Trust Cash from the starting inputs. All match the workbook.

Already net of tax	USD	Tax still owed on withdrawal	USD
Trust Cash	352,138	Ian's IRA	430,342
Joint brokerage	196,804	Stacey's IRA	611,874

Bank of America stock	64,467	Traditional 401(k)	84,556
Roth 401(k)	39,021	SIPP	181,360
Deposit	30,654		
Subtotal	683,084	Subtotal	1,308,132

- The plan taxes the RMDs as they are taken, and the cash flows are net of that. The $1.31M on the right is what remains in those accounts at end-2032, before tax. The brokerage and stock figures are also before tax on unrealized gains.
- The SIPP uses $1.30 per pound. The rate was about $1.347 on 4 November 2026, so the plan is conservative by roughly $6,500 in 2032.

4. Tax validation

I rebuilt federal and California tax for 2026 to 2032 independently, using the workbook's income for each year and my own rules and parameters.

Federal tax	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032
Workbook	64,320	46,313	45,440	56,106	59,202	58,528	11,804
My calculation	64,320	46,313	45,440	56,106	59,202	58,528	11,804

- Federal matches to the dollar every year, including 2029 to 2031 when the CTP payment lands. Taxable Social Security also matches.
- The 2027 federal parameters match the IRS figures published this month (standard deduction $33,200, 12% bracket from $25,600). Later years are 2.5% planning projections.
- The senior deduction is correctly zero from 2027. Income is far above the phase-out, and the deduction expires after 2028.
- The tax charged on RMDs is the actual extra tax from having them. The tax on Trust Cash interest is about 33%, which is correct once Social Security is 85% taxable.
- California is within about 3% of my independent figure. I had to estimate California's indexing, so it is not confirmed either way.

Sources

SSA 2027 COLA of 3.6%: ssa.gov/news/en/press/releases/2026-10-14.html. IRS 2027 inflation adjustments: irs.gov/newsroom (tax year 2027 release). GBP/USD $1.347 on 4 Nov 2026: tradingeconomics.com.